

be remotely controlled, or attached to sensors, so that you can achieve the exact lighting you want at the press of a button. There's also the SYLVANIA LIGHTIFY, by OSRAM, that is available at a price similar to the Philip Hue LED strips, but is compatible with the SmartThings and Hive controller, instead. So if you have a pre-existing SmartThings installation in your home, considering these LED strips would make more sense. In addition, many people prefer the absence of ambient light in their home theatre systems, since too much natural light can cause glare on screens, and lead to more washed out images. In such a case, remote controlled blinds, such as the ones mentioned earlier, can be used to give the room a more appropriate feel.

It is a prudent idea for people with even small budgets to start out with basic light automation, that would help reduce energy consumption, and hence, their electricity bill. And while everyone might not feel an extreme urge to invest hugely in such futuristic technology, any tech geek would certainly find this an engaging and creative field to invest in. **d**